

2024

# NORTH AMERICAN YOUTH ACTIVITIES

## ANNUAL REPORT









## Thank You Swamishri.

50 years ago, we never could have imagined the type of growth in pravrutti we have experienced in Bal-Balika, Kishore-Kishori, and Yuvak-Yuvati activities in North America. **However, as a result of Pramukh Swami Maharaj's and your tireless vicharan, precise vision, and endless motivation, we are humbled by the opportunity we have been given to support activities such as the ones detailed in this report.**

Swamishri, you more than anyone have made 2024 such an incredible year. We started the year with Regional Karyakar Conventions (RKC) themed "Eni Rite Rit," where we learned how following your ideal life can enable us to tackle any situations in our lives and seva. You also gave us many opportunities for us to become closer to you. Through your immense involvement with this years summer shibir, you gave us the mission to celebrate our "Andar Akshardham" and guided us as we built the Akshardham within. **As we end this remarkable year and step into the next, we hope to embody all that we've learned and perform our seva with only the intent to earn your raajipo.**







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# Core Activities

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Sabha





In 2024, Bal-Balika mandals across North America conducted interactive and engaging weekly sabhas to help balaks and balikas explore Satsang concepts and develop personally. Through Satsang Knowledge Class presentations in sabhas, balaks and balikas gained a deeper understanding of the various aspects of Hinduism. To strengthen their connection to the Guru Parampara, each month also featured Prasang Varnan presentations focusing on the lives of our gurus. Along with all of the prasangs and lessons shared, interactive activities helped reinforce what balaks and balikas learned while fostering samp between one another.



As all of North America celebrated 50 Years of Satsang this year, a special “NA50 Sabhas” series was conducted in all bal-balika sabhas. **Balaks and balikas explored the history as well as key prasangs behind each decade of the past 50 Years of Satsang in North America.** These sabhas helped the balaks and balikas build asmita and increase their jodaan with satsang by understanding the rich history of how Satsang in North America came to be.



In 2024, Kishore-Kishori mandals across North America conducted weekly sabhas to help kishores and kishoris deepen their Satsang gnan, work on self-improvement, and learn more about the lives of Maharaj and our gurus. Throughout these sabhas, kishores and kishoris would engage in two presentations on topics ranging from Vachanamrut nirupan, Satsang concepts, Hindu traditions, personal development, and the Swaminarayan sampraday. In between these presentations, kishores and kishoris would sing monthly chosars. At the end of sabhas, they would listen to an ashirvad clip from Pramukh Swami Maharaj or Mahant Swami Maharaj and perform manan before splitting into groups for goshtis.



Specifically for the year of 2024, the kishore-kishori sabha curriculum consisted of monthly NA50 sabhas to commemorate 50 years of Satsang in North America. **These sabhas would go deep into Pramukh Swami Maharaj and Mahant Swami Maharaj’s vicharan in North America that laid the foundation for the Satsang we see today.** Toward the end of 2024, kishore-kishori sabhas presented 6 episodes of NA50 documentaries for six consecutive weeks, to cap off this eventful year.





In the year of 2024, Yuvak-Yuvati Sabhas and Goshthis included topics related to celebrating the 50th Anniversary of satsang in North America. Topics covered in each sabha and goshthi included discussions of spiritual concepts, message-based stories from the Swaminarayan Sampraday, and personal development points related to growing in satsang and balancing challenges faced in our personal lives.

To build upon a sense of excitement from the 2023 vicharan of Mahant Swami Maharaj to North America and the monumental opening of the Robbinsville Akshardham, monthly special sabhas were held to celebrate North American satsang's journey from the opening of our first mandir in North America in 1974 to today. Towards the end of the year the celebration in sabhas culminated with a 6-week documentary series shown in sabhas to highlight key milestones in North America satsangs development over the last 50 years.



Goshthis were also held monthly to allow yuvaks and yuvatis a chance for each of their respective mandals to come together, enjoy time together, and discuss satsang topics as a group and build atmiyata



Near the end of the year, special recap sabhas were held to highlight messages from the Andar Akshardham Summer Shibir and to reflect on key messages shared by Swamishri on how yuvaks and yuvatis can continue to progress in Satsang.

## Gujarati Classes

We firmly believe that our **matrubhasha** (mother tongue) is a vital medium for transmitting satsang knowledge and culture to future generations. BAPS utilizes interactive and engaging methods to teach its native language Gujarati to Bal-Balikas across North America. In 2023-2024, significant technological enhancements enabled us to achieve standardization and stronger engagement at all levels. We successfully increased the number of students attending our Gujarati classes by 10% from 2022-23, reaching a total of 5,607 registered Balaks and Balikas, including **over 400 new students** who were not previously in our system. This year, we also transitioned most of our centers to in-person classes after COVID, with the **goal of achieving 100% in-person classes by next year**. Each year we add more centers, which help maintain or increase our Bal-Balika Sabha attendance.

We operate over 100 centers where Gujarati classes are conducted, supported by more than 1,000 dedicated Gujarati Karyakars with help of Parent Coordinators. All of these balaks and balikas are following Pramukh Swami Maharaj's vision of learning to read, write and speak the Gujarati language.

**5,607**

Total Registered  
Balaks & Balikas 2024

**100+**

Operating Centers  
in North America

**1,000+**

Dedicated  
Gujarati Karyakars

## Satsang Exams

Over **2,000 Balaks/Balikas, 1,800 Kishore/Kishoris, and over 1,000 Yuvaks/Yuvatis** have the unique opportunity to enhance their Satsang knowledge and deepen their understanding of our BAPS Sanstha through Satsang exams. These exams serve as a **powerful medium for them to connect more meaningfully with their sadhana**. By participating in Satsang exams, they can imbibe the teachings of Bhagwan Swaminarayan and our revered Guru Parampara, integrating these values into their everyday lives. Additionally, these exams are a way to earn the blessings and rajipo of Mahant Swami Maharaj, who has often emphasized that Satsang exams are the key to Akshardham. The exams not only help build spiritual knowledge but also encourage a deeper, lifelong connection with the principles and teachings of the Sanstha.



# Bal-Balika Sampark

The aim of Sampark is to build a solid relationship between a family and the mandir. On a regular basis, this involves karyakars connecting with parents and children to ensure they stay engaged with the mandir and its programs. This effort emphasizes regular communication with parents to understand their concerns and promote their engagement in various BK activities and events. Our Gurus have shown us that a simple connection is not enough, but a genuine connection is required. In 2024, with the restart of summer shibirs, the efforts of karyakars in establishing genuine connections became evident. After the COVID years, this summer shibir was our first major event for many balaks and balikas. Parents were not comfortable sending their kids to the event. Karyakars listened to the parents concerns and surpassed their expectations, helping them feel comfortable sending their kids to this year's shibir and many more going forward. Sampark is just as much about reaching out as it is listening. In 2024 we listened to our parents more than ever, are establishing a means to help them stay connected to mandir.

# Kishore-Kishori Sampark

Maharaj says in **Vachanamrut Kariyani 12, “Je je sukh tame satsang ma anubhavta hoy, tene bijāne janāvvu to samparknu kām chhe.”** The goal of Sampark is to foster strong connections between parents and Kishores/Kishoris, ensuring that they remain engaged with the mandir and its activities. This initiative focuses on maintaining regular communication with parents to understand their needs and encourage participation in various BK projects and events. By reaching out to parents, especially when a Kishore/Kishori misses a Sabha or KST, Sampark aims to motivate consistent involvement, reinforcing the community bond and spiritual engagement. After COVID, in 2024, events like Diwali, KST, the Amrut Cup/Yogi Cup, hangouts, summer shibirs, sleepovers, samaiyos, walkathons, satsang exams, and summer day camps took place, strengthening community ties and enhancing parental involvement. On a day-to-day basis, Parent Karyakars play a crucial role in this networking effort. They keep parents informed about upcoming events, address any concerns regarding their children, and gather insights into the interests of the Kishore/Kishoris. For instance, Parent Karyakars actively connect with parents during mandir gatherings and establish dedicated groups to share information about events.



# Yuvak-Yuvati Sampark

2024 marked a revival of core activities within all of North American Satsang, and Yuva Mandal was no exception. Following the completion of Akshardham, many yuvaks and yuvatis returned home after doing seva, and with that coincided the efforts to restore activities to pre-pandemic levels. With a full complement of yuvas back in their home centers, networking activities became a central focus. Goshthis were encouraged to contain a networking event and to be held outside of mandirs to create a more informal environment. External outings such as sports events, outdoor games, and hikes have been held throughout North America to help build atmiyata within mandals and welcome yuvas who come less frequently. Networking efforts were also linked to the return of summer shibirs, specifically to welcome in new yuvas, and those who had decreased attendance over the last few years.

There has also been an effort to increase larger networking events as well. In the Southwest region, the first ever Yogi Cup basketball tournament was organized for yuvaks to be able to meet from across the region. In Edison, a basketball recreation league was created that allowed yuvaks to spend quality time with each other in a comfortable mandir setting. Los Angeles took advantage of the outdoors and organized several hikes and outings including pickleball, paintball and a pool day. Similarly, yuvati mandals had great success organizing creative events across all the regions. Some examples were game nights, “bring a board” and other themed brunches, dressy dessert night, paint classes, and yoga classes took place in yuvati mandals in Atlanta, Dallas, Detroit, Edison, Houston, Los Angeles, and San Jose. Overall, all of our yuvati mandals made efforts to organize at least two of these events this year – and it was a wonderful reflection of mandal karyakars coming together to plan, execute, and showcase a creative way for yuvatis to stay connected to each other! For all of these yuva sampark examples, the mandals came together to plan out details and ensure things went smoothly. Their teamwork was commendable, provided a great experience for those attending, and a good footing moving for similar events to be hosted into 2025.







# Local Karyakar Meetings

Throughout 2024, local karyakar meetings were conducted on a regular basis to ensure teams were working together towards the progress of the mandal. Yogi Vimarsh helped align all of the different mandals within the center to ensure all teams were on the same page. It was an ideal medium to facilitate inter-wing communication. Additionally, BKY Local Activity Meetings (LAM) provided a platform to streamline project planning and implementation by bringing all karyakars on the same page regarding the state of the mandal and upcoming projects.

# Campus Hangouts

Campus hangouts continue to give college kishores and kishoris a place to connect and build their satsang community within a campus setting. We have seen **over 40+ campuses across North America conduct regular hangouts** within their campus community to help build atmiyata and a support system for these students. In addition to Campus Diwali celebrations, activities such as final exam care packages, admitted student tours and Pujya Santo hangouts have allowed campus pravrutti to flourish. It is the first time since pre-COVID, that we have resumed full campus hangout activities across all campuses across North America. Kishores and kishoris have cited that these vital connections have helped them flourish in their studies and grow their satsang foundation while being away from home.



# Bal-Balika Remote Virtual Sabhas

Many balaks, due to the distance from their local mandirs, are unable to attend regular sabhas and deepen their connection with the Satpurush. To address this challenge, a new program called virtual sabhas was launched. These virtual sabhas provide individuals with the opportunity to participate in our sabhas, learn about satsang, and establish a meaningful connection with the Satpurush even though they may live hours from a mandir. The first virtual sabha took place on October 13, 2024. We found 88 families that lived too far from our current Mandirs to attend regular sabhas. While we are still in the process of ramping up this initiative, approximately 50% of those who showed interest have already participated in at least one virtual sabha. This positive response indicates a strong demand for this virtual offering and highlights the need for flexible options to stay connected with our spiritual practices.

In addition to the virtual sabhas, we are encouraging families to make the effort to travel to mandirs for samaiyos, even if they are located far away. This is part of our ongoing effort to foster a deeper connection with our culture and community by emphasizing the importance of in-person participation when possible. Through both virtual and in-person programs, we aim to ensure that all balaks and balikas, regardless of location, have the opportunity to engage with our traditions, strengthen their cultural ties, and cultivate a stronger bond with the Satpurush. These initiatives reflect our commitment to making our spiritual services more accessible and inclusive for families everywhere.







# Special Events

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# Kids’ Diwali Celebrations

The Kids’ Diwali Celebrations across North America this year were a success, providing children a meaningful connection to their roots while celebrating Diwali with joy and purpose. **Themed “Diwali – Illuminate the Light Within!”, the event focused on nurturing the inner virtues of compassion, truth, and humility in balaks and balikas.** Through a combination of creative stage programs and hands-on activities, and with the use of prasangs from the guru paramparā, children were encouraged to reflect on the deeper significance of Diwali, beyond the external celebrations of lights and fireworks. Prasangs of Bhagwan Swaminarayan, Param Pujya Pramukh Swami Maharaj, and Param Pujya Mahant Swami Maharaj were used to deliver messages of compassion and humility, showing the children how these virtues have been exemplified by the gurus. Further, virtues of Lord Ram from the Ramayan were highlighted to inspire the children to follow the path of truth with humility and compassion.

Centers had the option of conducting the event through either a stage program or a booth program or both. All options delivered the prasangs and messages in a creative and engaging way. The stage programs used performances, storytelling, and discussions to convey the key sub-themes of compassion, truth, and humility. Meanwhile, the booth programs allowed children to rotate through different interactive stations, where they participated in hands-on activities related to the stories of Bhagwan Shri Ram and the Guru Parampara. Whether through a stage presentation or booth activity, children explored these virtues in an experiential manner, gaining a deeper understanding of how to let their inner light shine.

In addition, remote centers leveraged a special concise program to deliver a smaller scale Diwali Sabha to their balaks and balikas. These focused on more general topics such as the five days of Diwali in addition to the main theme of illuminating the inner light. The smaller programs allowed these centers to still create a meaningful experience, ensuring that even those in remote areas could participate in Diwali celebrations with the same spirit and joy.

Alongside the educational sessions, children at all centers enjoyed festive treats, bouncy houses, and a variety of fun games. This combination of joy and reflection made the event a memorable experience for all attendees, leaving them eager to embody the values they learned.







# Campus Diwali Celebrations

Kishores and kishoris across North American university campuses proudly hosted the annual BAPS Campus Diwali Celebrations. This year, over 40 campuses across North America held the Campus Diwali Celebrations. Collegiate youths, often at remote campus locations away from friends and family, balanced their academic schedules to plan, organize, and participate in this event. In addition, the student karyakars hand-prepared various vegetarian food items to offer as an annakut, upholding cornerstone elements of the Diwali tradition. **Over 10,000 students, faculty, and community members participated in these celebrations.**

The program was themed “The Festival of Harmony” to share the feelings of harmony amongst loved ones that Diwali brings into our lives. Through the interactive exhibition and program, delegates learned how exactly one can achieve harmony amongst the world, with others, and within ourselves. In addition, this program enabled delegates to understand the origins of Diwali, practice some of its customs, and understand the importance of maintaining harmony. This culminated into a showcase of the “Landmarks of Harmony” by explaining the inspiring stories of the BAPS Hindu Mandir in Abu Dhabi as well as the story of North American Akshardham.



**40+**  
Campuses  
across North America

**10,000+**  
Attendees  
at Campus Diwali Events



# Education Seminars

The Education Seminar was developed to teach and prepare our Kishores and Kishoris about different educational and career pathways available to them. We do this by highlighting satsangis who have been successful in their careers and giving students an opportunity to ask and learn about their educational journey so they can get inspiration and plan. As part of the seminar, there is a panel discussion where satsangis who are notable in their fields answer frequently asked questions about how to prioritize time, what opportunities to look out for, and how to balance satsang with their careers. In addition, a networking session is hosted where students can meet and engage with professionals to receive more guidance for their specific circumstance. Finally, there is also a Parent Session where parents of recent graduates share their experiences around supporting their child throughout the entire graduation, college planning, and career planning process. Overall, one of the main takeaways is creating a spark to start conversations about career planning.





# Summer Shibirs

As the magnificent BAPS Swaminarayan Akshardham in Robbinsville neared completion, Param Puja Mahant Swami Maharaj imparted a profound message: "Our lives should reflect this extraordinary and divine Akshardham. **The physical Akshardham has been built. Now it is time to build the Akshardham within.** Only then is our goal complete." That vision shaped Andar Akshardham the 2024 Bal-Balika, Kishore-Kishori and Yuvak-Yuvati Summer Shibirs.

25 | Bal-Balika Summer Shibir  
27 | Kishore-Kishori Summer Shibir  
29 | Yuvak-Yuvati Summer Shibir





# Bal-Balika Shibir

The 2024 North American Bal-Balika Summer Shibirs took place from June to August 2024. **Over 5,500 children of ages 7-13 from across North America participated in these three-day shibirs.**

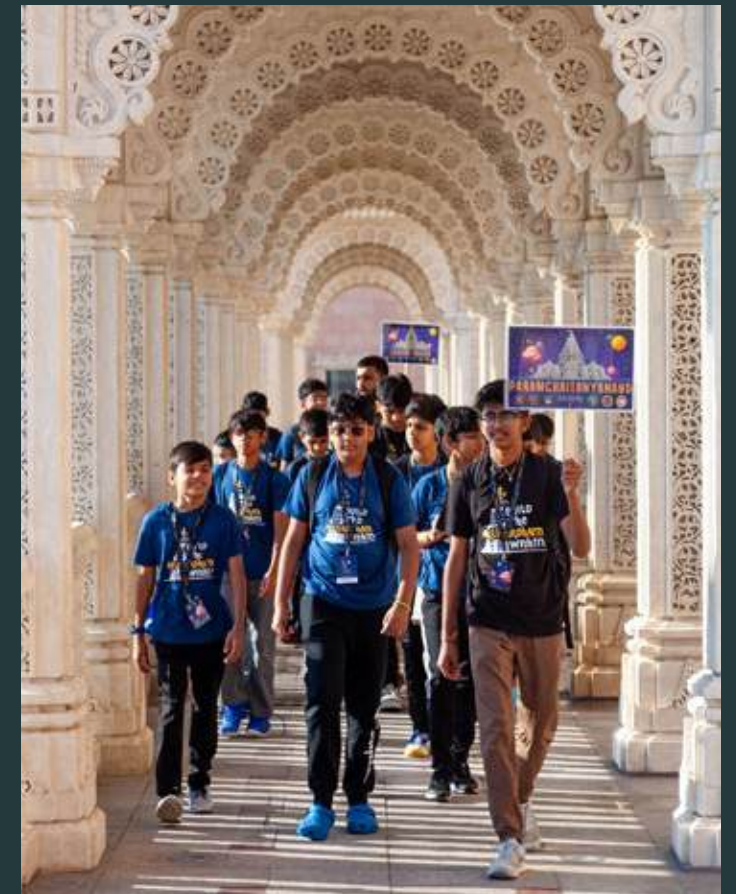
The shibir began with a program commemorating the past 50 years of Satsang in North America. This musical program, highlighting prasangs of our gurus' love and care for balaks and balikas over the past 50 years of North America Satsang, served as a tribute to the tireless travels our gurus have done in North America. Through this program, the overarching theme of the shibir was introduced through the posed question: 'Swamishri has done so much for us. Now, what can we do for him?' That is, now it is our turn to fulfill Swamishri's vision for us, which is to build our "Andar Akshardham".

The messages used to explain how to build "Andar Akshardham" focused on Ekantik Dharma: dharma (righteousness), gnan (spiritual knowledge), vairagya (detachment from materialistic possessions and attachment to Bhagwan), and bhakti (devotion to Bhagwan).

Each element of Ekantik Dharma was broken down and presented as practical messages to help delegates understand and implement them into their lives. Delegates learned that their Dharma is to follow the niyams laid out by Maharaj and Swami, to become ideal students, sons and daughters, and satsangis. Further, they learned that to imbibe Gnan, they must read prasangs daily and contemplate on them, helping to develop a deeper bond with Bhagwan and the Satpurush. Doing this enhances our understanding of their greatness. Vairagya focused on avoiding detrimental screen time, revealing how much time can be dedicated to Satsang when we eliminate time-wasting activities. Finally, Bhakti emphasized the importance of performing daily spiritual rituals (ahniks), allowing ourselves to spend the entire day with Bhagwan and the Satpurush.

In between each of these main sessions, delegates gathered into groups to discuss the practicality of what they were learning through games, discussions, and personal notes.

The culmination of the messages boiled down to one objective: pleasing the Guru. By aligning all daily actions to please the Guru, one can actively implement dharma, gnan, vairagya, and bhakti into their life, thereby building the Akshardham within. This approach leads to happiness, contentment, and a profound excitement towards satsang.





# Kishore-Kishori Shibir

The 2024 North American Kishore-Kishori Summer Shibirs took place from June to August, bringing together **over 5,000 high school and college-aged youths from across North America for transformative three-day events.**

The key messages of the shibir focused on two main pillars: agna, the divine guidance of God and Guru, and upasana, the philosophy that true attainment comes through a God-realized Guru. Delegates learned how to follow agna with the right mindset and to develop faith in God and Guru as sarva-karta-harta (all-doer) and pragat (manifest) on this earth in the form of Mahant Swami Maharaj.

The first three sessions emphasized understanding and experiencing “Akshardhamnu Sukh”—the happiness of Akshardham. Delegates discovered that to feel this sukh, they must actively build the Akshardham within themselves, starting with understanding the mahima, or greatness, of the Guru. They also reflected on their personal relationship with Swamishri, recognizing that they can rely on him to guide them through life’s challenges. Through discussions, delegates shared how their Gurus have been present during life’s highs and lows—whether through the mandir community or Swamishri’s letters and prayers—helping them juggle school, professional, and family responsibilities while trusting their Guru to lead them in the right direction.

Sessions four and five deepened the discussion on building trust in one’s Guru. Delegates explored how trusting Swamishri motivates them to follow agna, even amid the pressures of school, family, and social dynamics. They were given powerful examples of how individuals remained steadfast in the most extreme situations. They learned that, with faith in Bhagwan’s kartapanu (all-doership) and in the pragat Satpurush, Mahant Swami Maharaj, they can overcome hardships by drawing strength from their connection with the Guru.

In the sixth and final session, delegates heard from Mahant Swami Maharaj and other swamis on how to apply the teachings of Akshardhamnu Sukh in their daily lives. They discussed the challenge of balancing their identity in school with their spiritual identity at the mandir, learning that by following ahnik, reading inspiring incidents, and reflecting on thier memories of the satpurush, they can create a routine filled with opportunities to stay connected to Bhagwan and Guru. With this mindset, kishores and kishoris resolved to follow Swamishri’s agna and prioritize Satsang in their lives.

Additionally, some regions held special Welcome Day programs celebrating 50 years of Satsang in North America, featuring cherished memories from haribhakto and a kirtan aradhana highlighting significant events, honoring the legacy of Pramukh Swami Maharaj and Mahant Swami Maharaj.

Throughout the shibir, delegates dove deep into the principles of agna and upasana, aligning themselves with the vision and wishes of their Guru, Mahant Swami Maharaj, as they began to build the path to keeping Akshardham within.





# Yuvak-Yuvati Shibir

Over 2,100 Yuvaks and Yuvatis across North America’s six regions attended the shibir, the first regional shibir in five years. Over the course of the three days Yuvaks and Yuvatis learned that focusing on the divine attainment of God and Guru (Prapti) and reflecting daily, one can experience true happiness within satsang. Moreover, making genuine efforts (Purusharth) in our satsang, through our daily ahnik, will help us in making consistent, incremental progress towards building our Andar Akshardham. Finally, the Yuvaks and Yuvatis learned how to feel fulfillment (Krutarthpanu) throughout their Satsang journeys.

Before departing the shibir, Mahant Swami Maharaj ensured the Yuvaks and Yuvatis that he **“will support your every effort on this lifelong journey”** to build the Akshardham within. Yuvaks and Yuvatis left with a refueled excitement towards their personal satsang.







# Yogi Cup

The Yogi Cup sports tournaments were executed throughout North America this year, bringing together kishores and yuvaks from across each region. These multi-day events provided a lively platform for kishores and yuvaks to embody the values of Yogiji Maharaj and Param Pujya Mahant Swami Maharaj - **Samp, Suhradbhav, and Ekta** - through spirited sports competitions.

Enriched by diverse activities like evening programs, goshtis, and daily ahnik, the tournaments offered an immersive experience of “gnan saathe gamat” and celebrated the collective spirit of Samp. The Yogi Cup also played a crucial role in outreach, reaching kishores and yuvaks less involved in our mandirs.

Amidst the sporting events, the bonds formed throughout regional events, created an atmosphere where attendees could reconnect with familiar faces and make new friends, all within a relaxed and congenial setting.



# Amrut Cup

The two-day Amrut Cup event brought Kishoris and Yuvatis together to foster relationships among players from various centers, exemplifying the teachings of unity, solidarity, and oneness. Every serve, spike, and cheer reflected the principles of samp, suhradbhav, and ekta, reinforced during morning programs that emphasized the games’ true purpose: strengthening bonds. The tournament highlighted the importance of communication and teamwork, as teams relied on mutual trust to navigate moments of pressure, underscoring the need to integrate these values into daily life.

In 2024, the West and Northeast regions of America participated in the Amrut Cup. Notably, the Northeast hosted its first Kishori-Yuvati Amrut Cup Volleyball Tournament in Hillsborough, NJ. The number of Kishoris attending the Amrut Cup **increased from 276 in 2020 to 451 in 2024**. The inaugural Kishori-Yuvati Amrut Cup was made possible by the dedicated efforts of local and regional volunteers, whose unwavering support created an environment where Kishoris and Yuvatis could flourish in their satsang journey.

Similarly, Yuvaks in the Northeast and Midwest also participated in their own Amrut Cup – a Volleyball focused sports tournament. Like Yogi Cup, Yuvaks enjoyed the company of their peers through these regional events and formed lasting friendships.







## Akshardham Academy

As the summer vacations come to an end, we are delighted to share the success of the Summer 2024 Akshardham Academy. Guided by the insightful direction of Pujya Ishwarcharan Swami and Pujya Anandswarup Swami during their visit to North America, this program has now come to a fulfilling conclusion. This 6-week program provided kishores, kishoris, yuvaks, and yuvatis with the inspiration, guidance, and practices needed to elevate their personal Satsang and professional skills. The participants were able to shape a life of Satsang sadhana, commit to giving back to the Sanstha, and strive for professional excellence.

This inaugural session had **21 Kishore-Yuvaks and 14 Kishori-Yuvatis participate across 2 groups**. Through this program, participants resided on-campus in Robbinsville and immersed themselves in developing their Satsang through various activities including: daily katha varta by Pujya Swamis, goshtis with Pujya Swamis and senior devotees, regular daily personal and group ahnik to solidify habits, daily Satsang reading & Prapti no Vichar, samuh seva

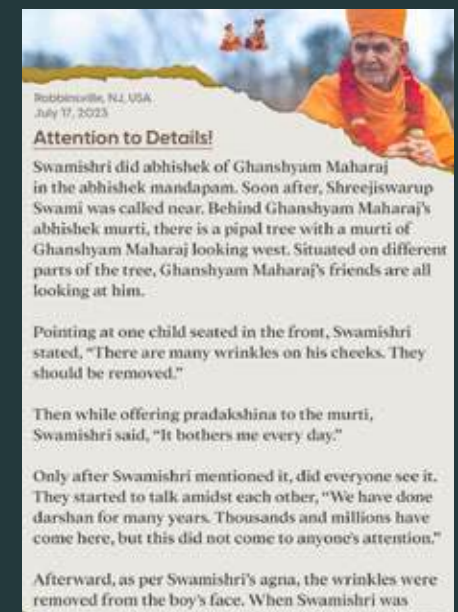
The program also focused on equipping participants with professional and practical skills. Karyakars engaged in seva at Akshardham led these sessions, complemented by workshops conducted by high-achieving Satsangi professionals from across North America. These sessions, which took place on weekends either in-person or virtually, provided valuable insights. Participants concluded the program by presenting what they had learned and applied in their seva to their peers, showcasing their growth over the six weeks. The Akshardham Academy has indeed been a transformative experience for all involved, laying a strong foundation for the future contributions of these young individuals to both Satsang and their professional lives.



## Moments With Mahant Swami

A year ago, on Shri Hari Jayanti, the “Moments with Mahant Swami” Telegram channel was launched. This initiative aimed to connect kishore-kishoris and yuvak-yuvatis with our beloved guru, Mahant Swami Maharaj, by sharing his inspiring life stories in English. Since its inception, the channel has captivated thousands, offering a daily dose of unique prasangs that reveal the depth of Swamishri’s spiritual qualities. By immersing themselves in these prasangs, devotees have gained a profound understanding of the incredible guru they have been fortunate to attain. Last year, on Swamishri’s 90th birthday, he expressed his wish for us to “Do 15 minutes of prapti no vichar daily.” The “Moments with Mahant Swami” channel embodies this very principle, enabling devotees to connect with Swamishri’s teachings and internalize his divine qualities. From his tireless vicharan to his compassionate care for haribhaktos, every prasang offers a glimpse into Swamishri’s extraordinary life. These stories inspire the members of this group to reflect on their own spiritual journey and strive for higher ideals.

Behind this inspiring initiative is **a dedicated team of 4 santos, 7 bhaio, and 5 behno karyakars**. They tirelessly curate and share prasangs, along with supplementary content, to help channel members relive those memories. Today, **nearly 9,020 individuals have been touched by Swamishri’s teachings through this channel, and over 230 unique prasangs have been shared**. The “Moments with Mahant Swami” channel continues to be a source of daily inspiration, allowing devotees to learn from Swamishri’s life, interact with him spiritually, and experience transformative moments that elevate their satsang.



## Pramukh Sanskritam

In 2024, BAPS launched the Pramukh Sanskritam Satsang Diksha initiative to fulfill Pujya Mahant Swami Maharaj’s vision of teaching youth the Satsang Diksha Shloks in Sanskrit. This program fosters spiritual and linguistic growth in North American participants aged 5 to 22. With 550 regularly attending weekly sessions before school vacations.

Guided by BAPS Pujya Swamis, students systematically learn 315 Shloks, with evaluations every 10 classes ensuring retention. Conducted virtually, the program is accessible to all, with parents and local mandirs supporting younger participants.

Graduates receive an e-certificate, and the flexible 52-week schedule accommodates diverse needs. With Swamishri’s guidance, the program aims to deepen participants’ connection to Satsang by helping them master all 315 Shloks.



# Karyakar Initiatives

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Meeting







## BST & KST

This past year, the Kishore Sevak Training program (KST) prepared kishores and kishoris across North America to strengthen their skills as karyakars through a variety of ways. During each KST session, kishores and kishoris would dive deeper into concepts core to our upasana and agnas in the Satsang Session. Kishores and Kishoris would also listen to an ashirvachan clip of our gurus discussing relevant Satsang concepts to directly hear from them on how we should interpret the teachings of our scriptures. To understand how concepts discussed in Satsang Sessions should influence one's daily life as a karyakar and Satsangi, kishores and kishoris would participate in a guided discussion during the Goshthi Session. Finally, kishores and kishoris would hone in on a particular skill during the KST Session through the Skills Session, aiming to prepare participants how to refine and improve their seva as karyakars. At the end of each session, kishores and kishoris would take a quiz assessing their grasp of the material covered in the prior month's session. Each semester would end with an ultimate exam that would be cumulative and test retention of concepts covered during the semester.

The 2024-2025 academic year saw **43 clusters across North America conduct 7 sessions** of Bal/Balika and Kishore/Kishori Sevak Training program. The program continues to emphasize building core Satsang concepts and foundational personal and professional skills.

Participants can expect both individualized and small group mentoring sessions; we partner 1 mentor to 5 delegates for an ideal experience. **We saw 550 balaks & 716 kishores and 352 balikas & 802 kishoris participate in the program.**

The delegates enjoyed purpose-driven and motivational talks from Pujya Swamis to provide further depth and clarity to satsang concepts. The program serves as an important cornerstone for delegates to become leaders and ambassadors for BAPS.



## Karyakar Goshthis

Karyakar goshthis plays a vital role in fostering unity and navigating through challenges, whether in seva or everyday life. They provide a platform for open communication, where karyakars can share their thoughts, experiences, and sentiments. Through this collective exchange, they build a sense of camaraderie and mutual understanding, strengthening their bond within each other and with Swami. By working together and pooling their diverse perspectives, they are more likely to come up with effective solutions. From topics relating to qualities of a true guru, leadership, Ahnik and Atmiyata to diving deeper into prasangs from Pramukh Swami Maharaj's cross-continent road trip in 1977, Cultural Festival of India in 1991, and the Millennium World Peace Summit in 2000, these goshtis are very insightful. The collaborative atmosphere also encourages a spirit of support and trust, making it easier to face challenges as a unified group, which helps to maintain dhanipanu in seva. By viewing seva as a means to fuel their sadhana, karyakars find deeper motivation and commitment to both their personal and spiritual growth.



## Nilkanth Newsletter

In 2024, the BKY NDC team has been publishing a monthly Nilkanth Newsletter, meant to help karyakars across North America learn from one another and stay informed about important events like Summer Shibirs, NAAM, KDC, and more. Each edition features a special story, a karyakar-focused manan on a Satsang Diksha shloka, a prasang, vicharan updates, and an inspiring quote from Pramukh Swami Maharaj. A significant focus for 2024 has been the integration of Yuvak Mandal into the Nilkanth team, with increased coverage of Yuvak Mandal-related events. This initiative has expanded the newsletter's scope and relevance, fostering a more comprehensive understanding of Satsang activities across different age groups in North America.





# North American Activities Meeting

At the annual BAPS North American Activities Meeting (NAAM) held in Atlanta, GA, **over 700 dedicated BAPS volunteers came together** to strengthen their skills and strategies for effectively managing their various sevas. The event spanned several days, focusing on reviewing last year’s achievements, exploring areas for improvement, and sharing tools to tackle upcoming challenges.

Through a combination of workshops, interactive focus groups, and strategic planning sessions, attendees engaged in deep discussions aimed at overcoming common obstacles, enhancing communication, and building strong support networks within their teams.

This year’s theme, “Samp” was designed to encourage karyakars to make efforts in their personal satsang and implement concepts such as madad, milan, maafi, and mahima.

Mahima, or understanding the greatness of others, was discussed through a variety of mediums that encouraged karyakars to consider how having mahima for others plays a key role in staying motivated in their sevas.

Madad, or helping others without expectations, encouraged karyakars to consider how to support one another in their seva roles but also more broadly. Discussions, keynote speeches, and breakouts were designed to help karyakars dive deeper into this concept and understand what it means for them personally.

Milan, or coming together to achieve a common goal, gave karyakars an opportunity to reflect on how ego and jealousy play a role in hindering progress. These moments of reflection allowed for karyakars to recognize the importance of celebrating stories of samp and community among their fellow karyakars.

Maafi, or to tolerate, forgive, and forget, challenged karyakars to reflect on how forgiveness plays a major role in the peace they experience while doing seva. By forgiving and forgetting, karyakars learned that they are able to continue to foster an environment of samp.

The agenda also emphasized collaborative problem-solving and allowed karyakars to connect through team-building exercises, fostering a sense of unity and shared purpose. This meeting provided a solid foundation for a successful and impactful year ahead.







# Parent Awareness Sessions

Parents' awareness sessions play a crucial role in guiding families toward fostering a satsang-centric lifestyle. They provide valuable insights and practical approaches to integrating spirituality into family life, ensuring a deeper connection with Maharaj and Swami and promoting inner peace and purpose.



## Spring Session

In the Spring session, the focus was on raising a satsang-centric family, emphasizing that it requires dedication, commitment, and ongoing effort. The rewards of this lifestyle include a stronger spiritual connection, inner peace, and a sense of purpose. The session encouraged parents to incorporate satsang into their daily routines, making it a natural and enjoyable part of family life rather than a separate task. By maximizing the time parents already spend with their children, activities like ghar sabha can become more doable, creative, and fun, even while on vacation. This approach also helps children make better choices in their social lives, including on social media and with friends.



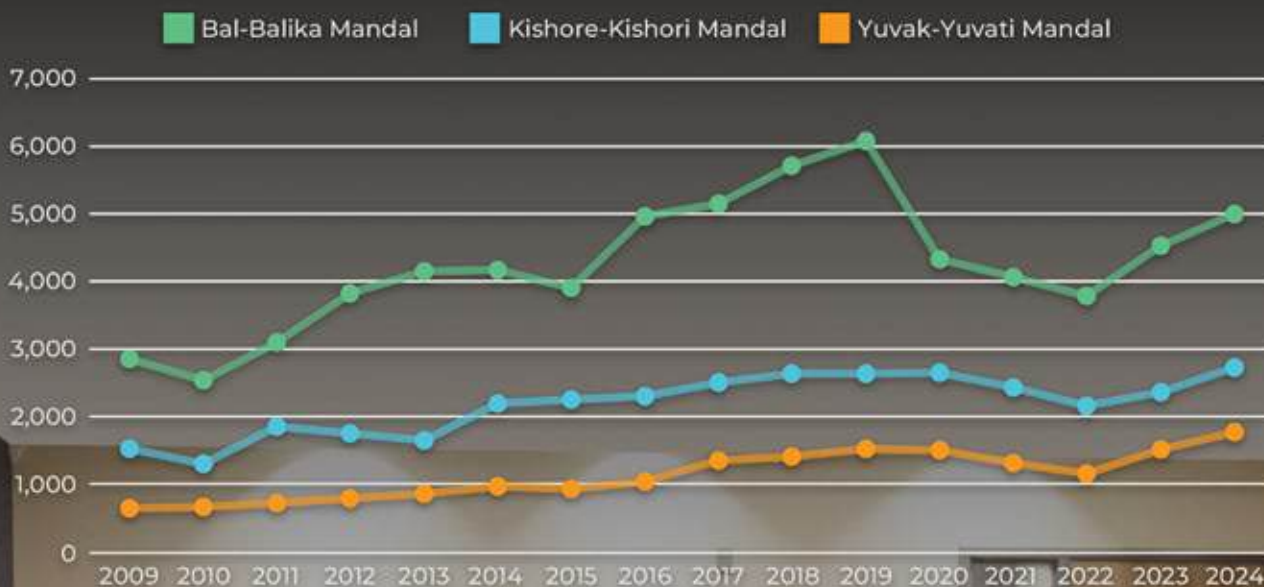
## Fall Session

The Fall 2024 session built on this by shifting focus from creative ideas for ghar sabha to the importance of parental presence, trust, togetherness, and engagement. The session emphasized that the quality of time parents spend with their children, both day and night, has a greater impact than formal activities like bal/balika sabhas. It encouraged parents to be mentally present, build trust, and foster a sense of togetherness, personalizing satsang in a way that children do not resent it. By doing so, parents can create a strong foundation for effectively engaging their children in satsang, ensuring it becomes a natural part of their lives.

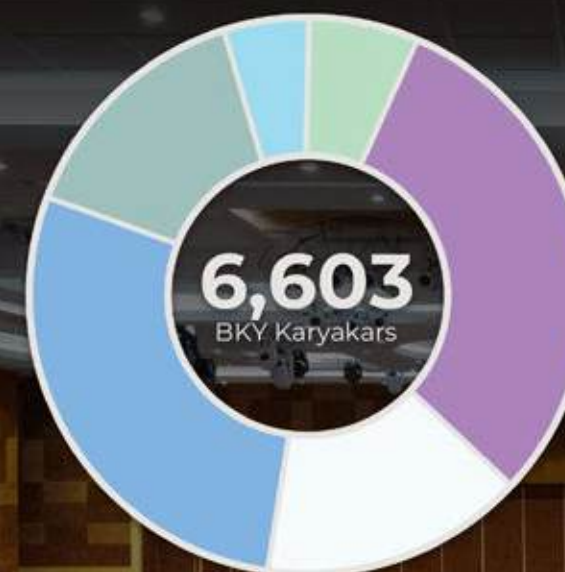
Both sessions highlight the importance of mindful parenting in raising spiritually grounded children, showing that integrating satsang into everyday life can be both meaningful and enjoyable for the whole family.



# 15 Years of BKY Growth



# BKY Karyakars in 2024



|                         |
|-------------------------|
| 1,894 Bal Karyakars     |
| 2,013 Balika Karyakars  |
| 949 Kishore Karyakars   |
| 1,005 Kishori Karyakars |
| 423 Yuvak Karyakars     |
| 319 Yuvati Karyakars    |



With the grace and inspiration of Mahant Swami Maharaj, coupled with continued guidance and support from Pujya Sadguru Santo, Pujya Motera Santo and the Pujya Sant team in North America, BKY pravrutti has continued to scale and has impacted the lives of so many.

We would like to thank the over **6,603 North American BKY karyakars** for their sincere, dedicated, constant, and wholehearted seva. They are the backbone of BKY pravrutti in North America, and without their seva, samjan, and sacrifice, the growth and progress of BKY pravrutti would not be possible.

We would also like to extend our humble thanks to each and every other wing with which we do seva. Their constant support has been instrumental in the progress of BKY pravrutti. They truly embody the samp that Param Pujya Mahant Swami Maharaj consistently emphasizes.

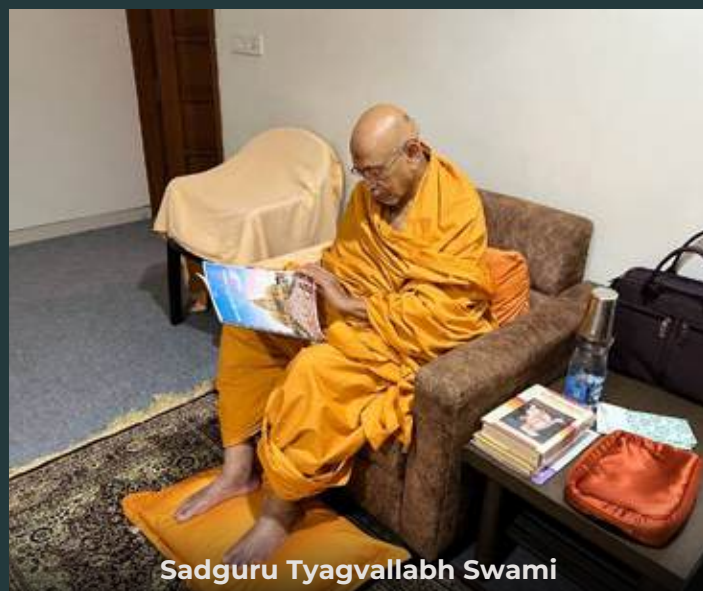




Sadguru Viveksagar Swami



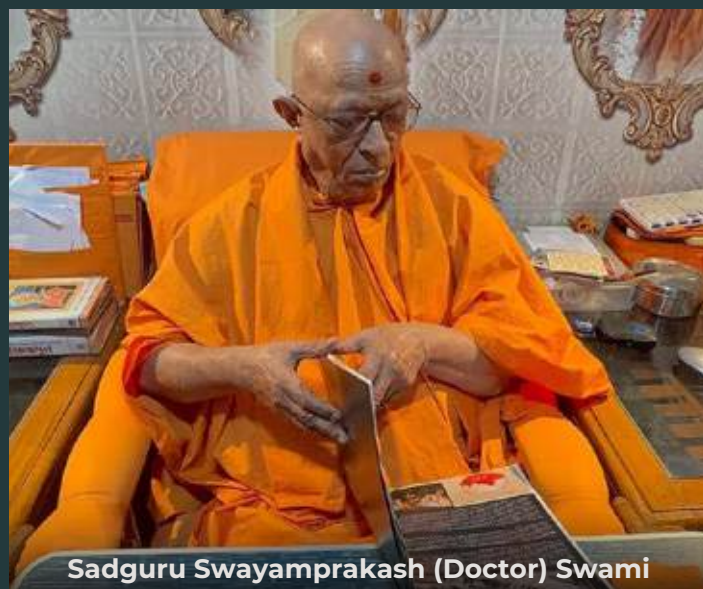
Sadguru Ishwarcharan Swami



Sadguru Tyagvallabh Swami



Sadguru Bhaktipriya (Kothari) Swami



Sadguru Swayamprakash (Doctor) Swami



Sadguru Ghanshyamcharandas Swami



Guruhari Mahant Swami Maharaj





2024  
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ANNUAL REPORT